

Post-Storm Roof Inspection Checklist

What to document after hurricane, wind, or hail — before repairs erase the evidence

Immediately after the event (from the ground)

- Record the date and time of the storm event and of your inspection.
- Photograph the property from all four sides, plus any roofing debris on the ground.
- Note lost, slipped, or visibly cracked tiles/shingles — and which slopes they came from.
- Check gutters and downspouts for dents, and for granule accumulation (asphalt roofs).
- Document damage to soft metals: vents, flashing, window screens, siding, decks, and vehicles — these corroborate hail size and direction.

Signs the untrained eye misses

- Tile uplift (“chattering”): wind-cycled tiles may look intact but have fractured attachments — loose, slipped, stress-cracked, or corner-cracked tiles fail in the next event.
- Bruises and fractures: hail can crack the fiberglass mat beneath an intact-looking shingle surface.
- Exposed underlayment anywhere — deterioration is exponential once the membrane sees sun and water.

Protecting the claim

- Do not make permanent repairs before damage is documented — temporary mitigation only (tarps), and keep receipts.
- Keep all displaced tiles, shingles, and components — physical evidence matters.
- Have a licensed engineer evaluate causation before accepting a scope — wear, prior damage, and storm damage are routinely confused, in both directions.

Need an engineering evaluation? TCE investigates storm losses nationwide — cause of damage and scope of repair, defensible under oath. 786-542-5474.

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